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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Date	Wednesday, February 11, 2026
Place	Senate of Virginia, Senate Chamber, State Capitol, Richmond
Length	6h 23m (video)

- Official floor video (Senate of Virginia, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JlOlgIKcJGc
- LIS Senate minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/S

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[00:29:58] sessions catch up on past meetings and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel the Senate will come to order the senators will please take their seats those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery the senators and all in attendance will

[00:30:37] please stand if you are able and be led in prayer today by the Reverend Taylor Louis Guthrie Hartman from the Second Presbyterian Church in Richmond and following the prayer everyone will please remain standing and be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by Senate page Claire Donahue of Essex. Let us pray. Holy One, you formed us to live in community as a people willing to stick it out trusting you always make a way

[00:31:13] out of no way. Keep us close today as those who govern among us make choices that reverberate into every corner of the Commonwealth. When we want to turn our backs on what frightens us, lift our eyes to our neighbors in need. When we are quick to anger and slow to mercy, tame our tongue and humble our heart. When division seems ideal because people are people, draw us near to one another. For For we cannot go it alone, can we God?

[00:31:52] Bind our collective hearts together as one. For our common purpose is that thy will be done, and done so in some small way through us today. Amen.

[00:32:08] I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:32:46] Clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye.

[00:33:12] The clerk will close the roll. You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal for Tuesday, February 10, 2026. The senator from Charlottesville moves that the reading of the journal be waived.

[00:33:31] All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their vote aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[00:33:50] Ayes 31, noes 9. Ayes 31, noes 9. The reading of the journal is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the House of Delegates. Senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[00:34:06] Madam President, I would move to waive the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived? all in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the Senators ready to vote?

[00:34:23] Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 31, noes 7. Ayes 31, noes 7. The reading of the communication is waived.

[00:34:40] The Clerk will report any communications from the Governor. We do not have any, Madam President. We've now arrived at the time in the morning hour when we have the honor of welcoming our distinguished visitors who are joining us today in the Senate gallery.

[00:34:57] And I give my daily reminder about our procedure. A senator will first rise and provide an introduction to their visitors. I will then offer the welcome on behalf of the Senate. I ask that we all hold our applause until I've had the opportunity to complete the welcome of the Senate.

[00:35:17] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Fairfax Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an introduction Senator has the floor Thank you, Madam President Conducting our invocation today was the Reverend Dr. Taylor Lewis Guthrie Hartman and she is the pastor of Second Presbyterian Church in Richmond, Virginia with a heart for mission, worship, and music in downtown Richmond and throughout the world Dr. Hartman has served in churches and ministries in Louisville, Boston, Durham, and Statesboro, North Carolina and a school in Brooklyn, but her heart home is Montreat, North Carolina. She was raised by the

[00:35:56] saints of her home church in Louisville, was trained in fine arts, sociology, and religious studies at Washington University in St. Louis, earned her master's of divinity from Harvard Divinity School, and her doctorate in ministry in creative writing and public theology at Pittsburgh Theological Seminary with a focus on poetry. In between all of that, she taught elementary special education through Teach for America and has been in some sort of staff or volunteer role at Montreat Conference Center almost every year since 2002. She shares her life with her artist and educator husband and their wonderful children. Madam President, I ask that we offer the Reverend

[00:36:32] Taylor Lewis Guthrie Hartman the warm welcome of the Senate. I thank the Senator for that introduction and thank you Reverend Hartman. What a list of accomplishments and I'll share with our guests who are joining us today, Reverend Hartman and I have a strong connection with Statesboro, Georgia, which we both have lived in. So it was delightful to have you here and thank you for your words of prayer and blessing for the Senate. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of

[00:37:06] the Senate to the Reverend Hartman. The chair recognizes the senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President, I rise for an introduction.

[00:37:24] - The Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. It is my pleasure to welcome participants with the Virginia Housing Allowances who are here for their Advocacy Day. More than 80 people from across the Commonwealth have joined us at the General Assembly to meet with their representatives and discuss critical issues related to housing affordability and homelessness.

[00:37:46] This year's visit is particularly special because it coincides with the Alliance's 10th anniversary. The organization traces its roots back over 40 years to the Virginia Housing Coalition and Virginia Coalition to End Homelessness with the Virginia Housing Alliance, often referred to as VHA, formed through their merger in January 2016.

[00:38:09] For the past decade, VHA has focused on expanding affordable housing opportunities and ending homelessness in Virginia. Please extend to the Virginia Housing Alliance the warm welcome of the Senate. I thank the senator for that introduction, and I see the representatives from VHA standing.

[00:38:26] Thank you so much for all that you are doing to address the issue of our housing crisis and to make sure that we are focused on this very critical concern. I hope you've had productive conversations throughout the day with our lawmakers.

[00:38:41] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of the Virginia Housing Alliance.

[00:38:56] - The chair recognizes the senator from Isle of Wight. - Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an introduction. - The senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Today in the Senate gallery, we have a very special guest, Mr. Malcolm Mitchell.

[00:39:12] Malcolm is a Super Bowl champion, a former wide receiver for the New England Patriots, and a proud graduate of the University of Georgia, where he distinguished himself both on and off the football field and the classroom. While many know him for his athletic accomplishments, his greatest impact, I would definitely say, has been his extraordinary dedication across our Commonwealth to literacy and education.

[00:39:33] After overcoming his early struggles with reading, he made it his life's mission to help young people discover the power and opportunity that literacy provides. He founded Share the Magic Foundation, make sure you Google that later, which has distributed hundreds of thousands of books to empower those to learn, especially with literacy resources to children across this country.

[00:39:55] He's inspiring students daily, and I've had the honor actually this year to reach over 1,000 elementary school students with him. And his commitment and dedication to just empowering students to learn to read is absolutely infectious. Here in the Commonwealth, Malcolm has supported students, educators, and community organizations focused on improving childhood literacy.

[00:40:15] And his outreach has positively impacted thousands of students across Southside Virginia, where his message of perseverance, education, and opportunity has made such a meaningful difference. And we're very, very grateful for him. His work reminds us of what true leadership should look like. It's not measured by just personal success, but also lifting others up and creating opportunity.

[00:40:35] His story is one of determination, resilience, and service. And he continues to be a role model every single day to the youth across Virginia. With that, I hope it would be the pleasure of this body and this chamber to welcome our friend that has such a love for Brunswick County and all of Southside, Virginia, Mr. Malcolm Mitchell.

[00:41:06] Certainly well-deserved applause. I just remind everyone that our protocol is that we will wait until I have offered the welcome of the Senate. But Mr. Mitchell, if you will please stand again. Thank you, thank you so much. Thank you to the Senator for that introduction.

[00:41:23] Thank you for all that you are doing for so many in our communities, especially around childhood literacy. We know how very critically important it is that we make sure all of our children have the skills and the resources, and having you as an exemplar in their lives, I'm sure is so uplifting for so many young people.

[00:41:44] So thank you for all that you are doing. Senators, I ask that we now give the warm welcome of the Senate to Mr. Malcolm Mitchell.

[00:42:03] The chair recognizes the senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for the purposes of two introductions. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President, members of the body.

[00:42:19] Today, this morning, you should have received in your offices a very special gift from Franklin County. A beautiful piece of cake from Empire Bakery. Now, I want to remind you that this proves that I'm not the only sweet thing that comes from Franklin County. And from what I'm hearing from a lot of senators, your aides intercepted the cake. You have not seen it yet. You may not see it.

[00:42:47] But I'll remind you also that when we had ice cream here, it came from Homestead Creamery. And now, I bring you more sweets as the chairman of the Diabetes Caucus. Madam President, members of the Senate, I rise in recognition of this company, Empire Bakery, that exemplifies the spirit of Southside, Virginia.

[00:43:11] It is based in Rocky Mount, Virginia, Franklin County. Empire Bakery was founded by Len Merrick and Danny Harris around 1980, born from a family tradition of baking that has grown into something truly remarkable. The company established its Virginia presence here in the Commonwealth in 1997 in Roanoke and relocated in Rocky Mountain in 2010, where it has called it home ever since.

[00:43:36] Today, Empire Bakery operates a 75,000-square-foot facility where skilled artisans hand-decorate cakes and desserts that reach families across this entire nation through major retailers like Kroger, Food Lion, and Wegmans. So when you go to Kroger and you see that red velvet cake, it's been handmade, handcrafted.

[00:43:54] And I visited this facility, and it was truly amazing what they do and how they do it. They bring quality, fresh products of baked goods to market every single day. They have the highest food safety certifications.

[00:44:11] Their products are kosher certified. And what makes Empire Bakery special is not just what they make, but what they mean to my home of Franklin County. This company employs more than 200 people, Madam President, in good-paying manufacturing jobs. They have invested more than $10.4 million in the Rocky Mount operations alone and have expanded three times, choosing Virginia over Utah, Texas, Arizona, and Oklahoma.

[00:44:37] They have been loyal to us, and we in Franklin County and in Virginia are loyal to them. Every time that they make a commitment to the Commonwealth of Virginia, they exceed it, delivering more jobs and more investment than they even promised. Empire Bakery proves that world-class manufacturing happens in small-town Virginia and can succeed in small-town Virginia.

[00:44:59] A family-founded business that bet on the Commonwealth nearly 30 years ago keeps doubling down and we all keep winning. Madam President, I'm proud to have Empire Bakery's commissary and their operation in the 7th Senate District. Today we have Eric Johnson, the Executive Vice President and General Manager of Empire.

[00:45:17] With him is Karen Gilliam, Corporate Sales Director, and I ask that you extend to them the warm welcome of the Senate and thank them for the delicious fresh cakes that they brought here to the Capitol, what it appears to be for our legislative aides to enjoy. I thank the self-proclaimed sweet senator from Franklin County for that introduction and what remarkable work your bakery is doing for the local

economy, for the workers that you are supporting. Thank you so much for sharing the delicious goodness with our legislative aides

[00:45:53] apparently. I'm sure we'll hear some reviews in the next couple of days. Thank you for joining us in the Senate gallery. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives from Empire Bakery. Senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. My second introduction is for some great people that actually I've been working with for many years.

[00:46:24] It's called the Patrick County leadership and they come up here every year and what they have in Patrick County is they get together some of our young talent, our young entrepreneurs, our young business owners, young members that work in our local government to really think forward in how we make Patrick County a better place to live, work and raise a family.

[00:46:43] How do we attract businesses and economic development? How do we preserve our values and our way of life? And so this year, we brought up, they brought up 15 members of leadership, Patrick County, and Madam President, I have the honor and privilege of taking them out to dinner every year, and I have to pick up the tap.

[00:47:03] 15 people can eat a lot of food, by the way, but I want to make sure that they know that as a lawyer, see, you can actually get something from a lawyer, not the other way around. So I'm happy to introduce them. I'm really proud of this group and what they're doing for Patrick County, and I wish them all the success And so they're here learning about local government state government right here at our capital, and they really are a great great group Summer Ojo de Agua Alicia Denny, Kristen Hilton, Betsy Lehmann, Stephanie Keith, Luke Williams, Diana Gazeva, Scotty Hilton, Noah Mabe, Wendy Merriman Hillary Holt, Joseph Young, Amy Nash, Sarah Ray from the Reynolds homestead and

[00:47:41] Julie Walters Steele from the Reynolds homestead she is their chaperone but these are great Virginians and I'd ask that you extend to them the warm welcome of the Senate thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to the Patrick County leadership cohort I'm sure you are learning quite a bit especially from our esteemed senator from Franklin County I hope you enjoy the dinner please order the most expensive items on the menu today and I know that each of you given your own skills and expertise are probably contributing as much to each

[00:48:20] other's understanding within the cohort as you are learning but thank you so much for your participation in this very important program senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Patrick County leadership the chair recognizes the senator from Arlington thank you madam president good afternoon I rise for the purpose of two introductions.

[00:48:49] The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. In the audience, the League of Women Voters of Virginia. Many members have decided to come and practice their Day of Advocacy. It's called the League Day.

[00:49:04] The League of Women Voters, as you know, evolved from the suffrage movement 106 years earlier. earlier there are about 2 000 members throughout the commonwealth in 15 local leagues the members of the league of women voters are continuing to advocate for the expansion of voting rights for all virginians and i hope it is the will of the general assembly to give them a very warm welcome thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to the representatives of the league

[00:49:40] of Women Voters, your work throughout so many decades has been truly transformative as you ensure that we have an educated and informed voting community so that we can all participate in this very critical civic responsibility that we each have.

[00:50:00] So thank you for your dedication, determination, thank you for all that you do, and thank you for joining us today in the Capitol and I hope you're having productive conversations with our lawmakers. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the League of Women Voters. Senator from Arlington.

[00:50:25] Okay, thank you, Madam President. The next introduction is the Statewide Transition Leaders Academy participants. They are joining us today because they care very deeply about how laws are made, but most importantly this group is dedicated to improving the post-secondary transition experiences and outcomes for young Virginians with disabilities. They are working hard to educate lawmakers on the importance of transition services for those with disabilities transitioning

[00:51:01] out of high school into uh workforce opportunities or educational opportunities i hope it is the will of the senate to give the trans the statewide transition leaders academy participants a warm welcome thank you thank you senator for that introduction and welcome indeed to the virginia division of career development and transition thank you for the critical and necessary work that you are doing to support so many young people along with their families in the critical period of their lives as they transition into into work

[00:51:36] opportunities. Thank you for all that you do. Senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Virginia Division of Career Development and Transition. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you so much Madam President. I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor.

[00:52:02] thank you madam president it is an honor to introduce and welcome students from the virginia state university department of social work and i ask that they please stand madam president housed within the college of humanities and social sciences one of the university's fastest growing departments is the school of social work 400 bachelor and master of social work students to serve communities across our commonwealth the students are joining us today in the general assembling in the capitol to put their expertise to work they're joining us to share their lived experience and they're joining us to make sure that we have a current and real-time perspective on the issues that we are deliberating so madam president

[00:52:39] I'd ask that not only do we give them the that we give them the warm welcome of the Senate thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to the Virginia State University Social Work Department students you are doing such critical and necessary work. We know how absolutely it is essential to have strong leadership in the area of social work so that so many of our families and individuals who need your support and your commitment are able to receive the services that they need. Thank you for all that you are doing and I'm hoping

[00:53:16] that you are having productive and good conversations with your lawmakers today. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Social Work Department from Virginia State University.

[00:53:37] The chair recognizes the senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The senator has the floor. Madam President, I am pleased today to introduce sheriffs

and deputies who have been participating in the Virginia Sheriff's Association's Legislative Day, including Richmond's own Sheriff Antoinette Irving, city of Richmond, and president of the Virginia Sheriff's Association.

[00:54:06] Established in 1933, the VSA is the only organization representing all of Virginia sheriffs, deputy sheriffs, and support personnel. VSA has almost 11,000 deputy and support staff members. Madam President, you probably recognize a face up there as well, our Chesterfield County's sheriff, Sheriff Carl Leonard. He runs the world-renowned and it really is a very impressive program called HARP celebrating 10 years helping addicts recover progressively. It's had the likes of Jelly Roll and I believe even Shibuzzi is supposed to be coming out. It has

[00:54:45] garnered the attention of so many people across the country. Sheriffs are as we know constitutional officers elected pursuant to article 7 section 4. Virginia sheriffs are responsible for running our local jails. Sheriffs are responsible for the service of process and provide security for our judges and courts keeping citizens safe during the judicial process. Madam President, I would ask that we would extend a heartfelt and warm welcome from the Senate. Thank you very much. Thank you Senator for that introduction and thank you to our representatives from the Virginia Sheriff's Association. I had

[00:55:24] distinct honor of welcoming you this morning to the office of the lieutenant governor and just the opportunity to hear from so many of you about the issues that you are prioritizing thank you especially for your leadership all that you do to build community trust and provide public safety and i know uh senator that uh sheriff antoinette irving who is the the president is not in our gallery but I know she's around here today and we certainly honor her leadership. Thank you to each of you who have joined us today and senators I ask

[00:56:01] that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to our representatives from the Virginia Sheriff's Association. Is there any other business for the morning hour?

[00:56:26] The clerk will call the calendar. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you Madam President, I would ask that we recess for about 20 minutes, and that upon the recess, the Senate Democratic folks could come back to the room back here so we could finish talking about the calendar this morning.

[00:56:52] Without objection, the Senate will be in recess for 20 minutes.

[01:03:26] The Senate will return to order.

[01:29:31] The clerk will call the calendar. Senate calendar for Wednesday, February 11, 2026. Regular calendar Senate bills on third reading. Senate Bill 348, a bill relating to storage of firearms in a residence where a minor or person is prohibited from possessing a firearm is present penalty.

[01:29:59] It's reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. Sorry, it was reported, but we have three floor amendments. Chair recognizes the Senator from Northern Fairfax.

[01:30:16] Thank you, Madam President. First, I'd like to reconsider the vote by which the bill was ordered be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall the vote by which the Senate bill number 348 was ordered to be engrossed and advanced be reconsidered? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any

[01:30:47] senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes

[01:30:58] 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. The motion is agreed to. Senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I waive the reading of the floor amendments. The question is, shall the reading of the floor amendments be waived? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The reading of the floor amendments are waived. Senator from Fairfax. Madam President, I move the floor amendments be agreed to and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:31:29] this is the safe storage bill that protects children and we had a robust conversation in which many colleagues on both sides of the aisle expressed concerns about the speed and the ability for someone to get into a biometric safe without trouble and so after careful consideration i have made an amendment that would allow an individual who had a gun at home who had their gun locked up to use either a combination lock a coded lock or a biometric lock as a as a way to

[01:32:07] make it more easy for folks this could be a loaded gun it is a policy change from what we've carried in the past and has passed through this but i think the republicans will be a little bit happier with it and that's basically that's that's basically the uh you i think you'll be more pleased with it because it does not require you to put your unloaded gun in one container and your ammunition in a second container this would allow you to keep it all in one container use a combination lock or a coded lock or a

[01:32:47] biometric lock and I move the amendment the chair recognizes a senator from Rockingham. Madam President, I ask if the patron would yield for question. Will the senator yield? Madam President, I yield. Senator from Rockingham as the floor. Madam President, I would ask the senator from Northern Fairfax, does this amendment allow every container or gun safe that qualifies for the tax credit that we passed a couple of years ago that we spend half a million dollars a year on

[01:33:24] to qualify under this. Senator from Northern Fairfax. Madam President as long as it follows the prescriptions here with it has a combination coded or biometric lock it does. Senator from Rockingham. Madam President speaking to the bill or to the amendment. Senator has the floor. Madam President I thank the Senator from Northern Fairfax. I think this does improve the situation. It still does not fully resolve the issue that I raised yesterday I believe concerning the tax credit I think we're still gonna have an underlying difference

[01:34:03] of opinion on the underlying bill but we are giving away $500,000 in tax credits every year for people to buy gun safes and what was a bipartisan effort to improve gun safety in the Commonwealth of Virginia I think that we've given money to a lot of people to buy a lot of gun safes and will continue to that will not qualify under this I think as I said it's better and I thank the senator from Northern Fairfax for that but I wish it was a little bit broader thank you madam

[01:34:37] president I am with that we have already discussed the policy underlying policy I'll just remind the body this is dealing with guns in the home if there are children or prohibited people present you have to lock your gun up and and um we know that guns are killed more children than any other cause in the in the state and in the commonwealth and i um ask that the uh i adopt the floor amendment the question is shall the floor amendment be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the ayes have

[01:35:15] it the floor amendment is agreed to senator from northern fairfax thank you madam president i move move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall the bill now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no.

The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Having discussed this bill and explained it thoroughly, I move that we pass the bill. We need to suspend the rules and dispense with the third constitutional reading. Madam

[01:35:49] President I move that we suspend the rules and dispense thank you senator the question is shall the rules now be suspended and we dispense with a third constitutional reading of Senate bill 348 all in favor of that motion will say aye I'm sorry it is recorded all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the

[01:36:18] senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. The chair recognizes the senator from Northern Fairfax. Madam President Almet, I'd

[01:36:53] ask that we can pass by it just temporarily. Without objection, Senate Bill 348 will go by temporarily. Ligis organizations, other nonprofit tax-exempt properties. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William thank you madam president move the bill

[01:37:29] pass and speaking to the motion senator has the floor thank you madam president this is the faith in housing bill we've got of nonprofit organizations willing to step up and help us with some of our critical need for housing across the Commonwealth a couple elements of the bill I just want to highlight and remind people any housing built under these provisions are taxable which I know is really important to localities so to get the tax revenue from the housing that's built it's no longer tax exempt so I know that's one thing that is really concerning to people and that was in the original version of the bill additionally you might recall that we included amendments yesterday which took care of

[01:38:04] 11 different locality concerns between archaeology historic districts and a number of other provisions that we adopted yesterday including military base sort of exclusion zones that are already in our code madam president and so with that we hope it's the body's pleasure to pass this bill and help us build partners to help us solve our critical need for housing across the Commonwealth. Thank you, Madam President. The question is, shall Senate Bill 388 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no.

[01:38:38] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18, Senate Bill 388 passes.

[01:39:01] Senate Bill 314, a bill relating to tourism improvement districts administering non-profits. The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria.

[01:39:18] Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. This bill does two things. It allows Arlington County or counties with the county manager form of government the flexibility to increase its resources and capacity for tourism promotion, driving demand to local hotels and hospitality businesses by establishing or updating our tourism improvement district code to allow for more of a public-private partnership relationship between a future tourism improvement district and the county, while still allowing other counties or localities to use the existing structure.

[01:39:54] Further, we'd let counties with a county manager form of government, just meaning Arlington increase their TOT tax surcharge to be increased from 0.25% to a ceiling of 1% to serve as a funding bridge while the Tourism Improvement District is established.

[01:40:12] This is much lower than other localities that have a TOT. The localities surrounding Richmond like Hanover, Chesterfield, and Ricoh, and I guess Richmond City could have 4%. Fairfax County County is double at 2%, Roanoke's 2%, Rockbridge County and Lexington and Buena Vista are 2%.

[01:40:32] So they're significantly higher than what Arlington's will be, but Arlington does account for 9% of the state's tourism and brings in a lot of revenue for the state, $86 million in tourist revenue, as well as $177 million in local. Again I move the bill pass.

[01:40:51] The question is, shall Senate Bill 314 pass? All in favor of the motion, we'll record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Senators ready to vote. Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 18. Ayes 20, noes 18. The bill does not pass.

[01:41:21] The required number for this bill is 21 votes. Senate Bill 60, a bill relating to Virginia Parole Senator from King George. Having voted on the prevailing side of Senate Bill 314, I move we reconsider that vote. The question is, shall the vote by which Senate Bill 314 did not pass be reconsidered? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to

[01:41:56] vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. The vote is reconsidered. Senator from Alexandria. Could that bill go by temporarily? Without objection, Senate Bill 314 goes by temporarily. Senate Bill 60, a bill relating to the Virginia Parole Board powers and duties,

[01:42:32] juvenile offenders, parole procedures, and considerations. Senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill passed in speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 60 deals with access to parole for individuals sentenced to life as a minor, and it addresses meaningful juvenile parole hearings and ensures that those eligible for juvenile parole hearings have a meaningful opportunity for release based on demonstrated maturity and rehabilitation. And by statutorily outlining parole procedures, the entire parole

[01:43:08] process in virginia will become more effective and with that explanation madam president i move the senate bill 60 pass the question is shall senate bill 65 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll it's 20 nos 19. ayes 20 Nose 19. Senate Bill 60 passes. Senate Bill 207. A bill relating to sudden unexpected death in

[01:43:48] epilepsy protocol information. The chair recognizes the senator from western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. This bill directs the office of the chief medical examiner to assess the feasibility of investigating SUDEP deaths. SUDEP is sudden unexpected death in epilepsy, and there is no known cause for these deaths right now. And the medical examiner will look at the feasibility of not only

[01:44:27] investigating them, but also referring the information to public or private institutions for inclusion in the Northern Virginia SUDEP registry, so we can finally try to figure out um why these folks are are passing away when they are otherwise seemingly healthy and with that i again renew my motion to pass the question is shall senate bill 207 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the

[01:45:00] senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll it's 39 no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. Senate bill 207 passes. Senate bill 224, a bill relating to tax administration award for

tax underpayment debt detection assistance. The chair recognizes the senator from eastern Fairfax. Thank you, matter president. Move the bill pass and speaking to that

[01:45:35] motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, matter president. Ladies and gentlemen, Senate bill 224 is a good I'm building here on a good Republican idea can you believe that this is a bill that I got from George W Bush George W Bush gave me this idea in 2006 the Internal Revenue Service under George Bush created a program that allows taxpayers who blow the whistle on tax cheats to get a portion of any taxes that are collected the only problem is that the IRS program doesn't apply if the

[01:46:13] taxes that are cheated on are state taxes so things like state income taxes or state gas taxes or state sales taxes and so what this bill does it allows us to give our taxpayers virginians an incentive to blow the whistle when they see somebody cheating on their state taxes i can't think of a better way to get more money in our system to get people who aren't paying their taxes who are supposed to to get them to pay tax fraud costs america three about 3.4 trillion dollars in the last decade. So what the bill does is that if you blow the whistle on somebody and it has to be

[01:46:51] somebody that has over a hundred thousand dollars or should have reported over a hundred thousand dollars income or business that has over half a million dollars of gross income if you blow the whistle and they collect some of that money the department taxation can award the whistleblower between 15 and 30 percent of the collective proceeds and there's built-in safeguards there's people that you know for example if you're being prosecuted for committing the tax fraud you can't blow the whistle on yourself or blow the whistle on something you participate in as a co-conspirator um there's installment plans there's provisions for that about you don't get you don't get your

[01:47:26] reward until the full installment's paid off um there's provisions of multiple people above the whistle on somebody to split that up but it's a proven federal model that the fed's been using now for almost 20 years and this just allows us to do the same thing at the state level with this good Republican idea. So I hope we can see a good bipartisan vote on this good Republican idea.

[01:47:50] The chair recognizes the senator from Rockingham. Madam President, I speak the bill. Senator has the floor. I look forward to my friend from Eastern Fairfax coming forward with other good ideas that maybe the president that President George W. Bush had and I appreciate his affection for President Bush, but this ain't East Germany, okay?

[01:48:19] We are not a country of snitches, nor are we here in the Commonwealth of Virginia. Why would we do this? Do you really think the IRS and the Virginia State Department of Taxation needs this kind of help? I think they do a pretty doggone good job sniffing out tax fraud on themselves.

[01:48:37] What we're doing is energizing a bunch of disaffected spouses in divorce contests or neighbors in boundary disputes, digging up mischief on their neighbors. I think this is a profoundly bad idea and we ought to vote against it.

[01:49:03] The question is, shall Senate Bill 224 pass? All in favor of the motion, will record their votes aye, those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[01:49:24] Ayes 23, noes 15. Ayes 23, noes 15. Senate bill 224 passes. Senate bill 229, a bill relating to civil actions filed on behalf of multiple persons class action violations of Virginia Consumer Protection Act

award of damages. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Move the bill to pass. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:50:01] Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, this is not a Republican idea. We are one of only two states in America where you cannot bring a class action lawsuit in state court. We're partnered right there with Mississippi, and that is not somewhere we want to be. No offense to the caucus chairman here, Senator from Hampton.

[01:50:31] Some of us are proud to be from Mississippi. But Madam President, this bill basically would allow people to file class action lawsuits in state court. You already can file a class action in Virginia, but you can only file it in federal court. And getting into federal court, you have to have a federal statute or you have to have more than $5 million at issue.

[01:50:49] And what that means is typically in like landlord-tenant situations or cases of smaller value that you normally find filed in state court, you can't bring them. And so the bill basically authorizes that. It's modeled on the federal rules of civil procedure. I can't tell you there's peace in the valley on this because there are businesses that don't like this, although there's some businesses that actually don't mind class actions because it helps them resolve a lot of liability at once. It's more efficient.

[01:51:16] This will unburden our courts. Oftentimes when there's a significant issue that results in a lot of cases, you end up seeing like 100, 200, 300 cases get filed in court instead of one. This bill will help solve that. We've also passed this, a version of this, I think twice before, maybe three times through this chamber before. The only other difference this year is it also clarifies a few things under the Consumer Protection Act, primarily one that you can get statutory damages on a per violation basis, which is I think what the law already is, but some people disagree with that.

[01:51:47] Secondly, you don't have to show reliance to have a civil action for a violation of the Consumer Protection Act. It reverses the Supreme Court case about 10 years ago about that. But that's what the bill does. I think it'll be a good access to justice bill. It'll allow a lot of people to finally have access to attorneys who normally don't.

[01:52:05] It allows people to have remedies when corporations steal money from people in small amounts, but from lots of people at the same time. And I hope we can pass the bill. The question is shall Senate bill 229 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed No, are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:52:29] The clerk will close the roll as 22 knows 18 eyes 22 knows 18 Senate bill 229 passes Senate bill 305 relating to kinship foster care barrier crime waiver senator from western fairfax i move this bill passed and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president um so currently any individual in the commonwealth who has previously been convicted of

[01:53:02] a laundry list of barrier crimes is automatically denied in the foster parenting process this bill establishes a waiver program for relatives or effective kin that would allow the appropriate state and local social services department to consider an approval for rehabilitated individuals who are now living um you know law abiding lives each waiver would review a number of factors including but not limited to the type of crime the time since a conviction the evidence of

[01:53:36] rehabilitation and community input and I thank my lawyer colleagues on both sides of the aisle for working on some of the language here to ensure that the most violent crimes automatically are

still excluded you are excluded from being able to go through this waiver process and with that I move the bill pass senator from Rockingham madam president I'm not gonna vote against this bill but I do want to say something about it speaking the bill senator has

[01:54:16] the floor we we passed kinship care legislation a year or so ago and I think it's a very good thing in my district in Augusta County just several years ago there was a little girl two years old named Khaleesi Cuthrell she was placed in the care of a friend of her mother's her mother was taken to she was in court on a drug offense I believe and was going to jail that day and she told the

[01:54:56] judge my little girls at home and I don't have any body to take her so can you give me the day to do something the judge said fine by five o'clock you need report she called her sister who was over the mountain in Culpeper asked her come over pick up her little girl she couldn't get over in time so what's a multiple-time drug offender do she calls somebody she'd been in jail with come

[01:55:32] and pick up her little girl and this person who picked up this little girl took her took her to her home where she lived with her boyfriend there's another multiple time offender the Department of Social Services showed up and basically said grace over this said yeah we don't have time to wait for your sister we think this is probably can be okay all right mom goes to jail and tries

[01:56:11] repeatedly to contact her daughter unsuccessfully she contacts Department of social services multiple times and is unable to make contact and finally officials go and find that she's gone she's gone there was photographic evidence that was recovered from the phones of the friend and her so-called

[01:56:46] friend and her housemate boyfriend showing the systematic torture of this beautiful little girl, showed her losing hair as a consequence of malnutrition, showed her suffering burns in being placed in a bathtub. We talked about this at great length about the need to make sure that we are establishing appropriate guardrails and one of the problems was that the local departments

[01:57:23] of social services were not doing their job. We need the state to step up and and make sure that these little children don't suffer these kinds of consequences.

[01:57:38] And I'm very concerned about taking away some of the responsibility of the state to really establish those guardrails. I don't trust putting this entirely in the hands of our local departments of social services at this point.

[01:57:57] I just don't. I think they are, by and large, very good people who care a lot about the job that they do. and try very hard to do the right thing, but sometimes they're overstaffed. Sometimes somebody may take the easy way out, sometimes it may be 5:15 and they've got something that they need to do.

[01:58:17] But these little boys and little girls are depending on us. And I just am deeply concerned, and I hope, I hope that, and I wasn't on the committee that looked at this, but I certainly hope that the Department of Social Services, and I hope that the patron, And I hope that everybody involved in this process will do your level best to make sure that the State Department of Social Services takes care of these children and doesn't let these predators, these people who have no business taking custody of these children, do so.

[01:58:57] So I will take your word for it that this is a good thing, but I'd do it with great reluctance and great hesitation. And I certainly hope that there are no more incidents like the horrible tragedy that befell little Khaleesi Cuthril.

[01:59:16] And by the way, she was never found. She was never found. Madam President. Senator, for what purpose do you rise? Senator President, can this bill go by temporarily? Without objection, Senate Bill 305 goes by temporarily.

[01:59:40] Senate Bill 308, a bill relating department of health reduction of drug overdose and drug overdose deaths report senator from western fairfax oh again madam president hopefully i'll be uh better able to do this one i move this bill pass and speaking to that senator has the floor all right so this bill just directs the virginia department of health to lead the development of a strategic plan to coordinate activities related to opiate overdose and overdose deaths including fentanyl in the commonwealth

[02:00:15] VDH shall convene the relevant state agencies and stakeholders to develop the strategic plan and report annually on its progress. This was a recommendation from the Joint Commission on Health Care and resulted from a staff study on policy solutions to the Commonwealth's fentanyl crisis.

[02:00:37] And this really just is going to bring all of the things that we are doing, all of the people who are involved in the opiate crisis under one umbrella and directed by the VDH. And I move that this bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 308 pass?

[02:00:57] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0.

[02:01:14] Ayes 39, noes 0. Senate Bill 308 passes. Senate Bill 364. A bill relating to the Department of Criminal Justice Services, Safer Communities, Firearms, Violence Intervention, and Prevention Initiatives.

[02:01:42] The senator from Eastern Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to the bill. The senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, this legislation modifies the Office of Safer Communities to serve as a statewide research and data clearinghouse dedicated to reducing gun violence by integrating information from state and local agencies.

[02:02:04] The office will serve as the Commonwealth's primary resource for research, best practices, and strategies for the implementation of firearm violence intervention, community-based intervention, and group violence intervention programs designed to reduce violence in communities. The office will facilitate coordination between state agencies, localities, and community-based organizations to develop comprehensive practices for addressing firearm violence and implementing firearm violence intervention and prevention programs.

[02:02:34] The question is, shall Senate Bill 364 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[02:02:54] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, Nose 19, Senate Bill 364 passes. Senate Bill 424, a bill relating to alcoholic beverage control, government stores, distillers licenses as agents of the board, sale of alcoholic beverages.

[02:03:15] Senior Senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that bill. Senator has the floor. Madam President, this is a bill that was brought to me

by our distilleries across the Commonwealth of Virginia, including one in my district, Catoctin Creek, up in Percival, Virginia.

[02:03:33] But what this bill does is it increases the poor limit to bring our distilleries more in line with our wineries and breweries. Our distilleries are struggling as small businesses here in the Commonwealth of Virginia, in part because of their very low poor limit that they have.

[02:03:48] This increases that poor limit to what would be about two margaritas that would be allowed to consume there at a distillery. So if you are a fan of small businesses and supporting small businesses and protecting our distilleries, promoting tourism and local agriculture, this is the bill for you.

[02:04:04] This bill keeps intact the same things that ABC currently does to supervise these places and make sure that they are abiding by the law. Madam President, with that, I move the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 424 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes.

[02:04:21] Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 36, noes 4.

[02:04:40] Ayes 36, noes 4. Senate Bill 424 passes. Senate Bill 515, a bill relating to commission on electric utility regulation scope and name change. Senator from Charlottesville.

[02:04:58] Madam President, I move that the bill passes. I'd like to speak to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, it's amended form. This bill, which is a recommendation on the Commission on Utility or Electric Utility Regulation, otherwise known as the sewer, or under the chair's perspective, it's called the cure, but I'm not sure how you get that out of CEUR.

[02:05:21] But it changes the name of that commission to the Energy Commission. It merges it with the Coal and Energy Commission, which has not met since 2021, and it adds two members of the state Senate. That's basically what it does. Because it's a merged commission, it has some expanded authority that relates to what the Coal and Energy Commission used to handle.

[02:05:43] Again, I hope you'll vote for the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 515 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[02:06:00] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, no's 19. Ayes 21, Nose 19, Senate Bill 515 passes. Senate Bill 519, a bill to direct the Department of Conservation and Recreation to assess the feasibility of achieving permanent conservation of 20% of the land area and 10% of the urban areas of the Commonwealth.

[02:06:35] Senator from Charlottesville. I move that the bill pass, and I'd like to speak to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President has introduced this bill had bold ambitions and it's formed before you.

[02:06:50] It's a section 1 bill that directs the Department of Conservation and Recreation to figure out how best to achieve the goal of conservation of 20% of the land area of our rural areas and 10% of the land area in urban areas and also to tell us how much money they expect it's going to cost and where the money's going to come from.

[02:07:10] that's all the bill does at this point I hope you'll vote for the bill the question is shall Senate bill 555 19 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready

to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 39 noes 1 ayes 39 noes 1 Senate bill 519 passes

[02:07:46] Senator Bill 536, a bill relating to medical malpractice actions, limitation on recovery, more prejudgment interest.

[02:08:04] The chair recognizes the senator from Rockingham. Madam President, I move the bill pass. Speaking to it. Senator has the floor. Madam President, members of the Senate, this is a bill that addresses the cap, but in a very small and very technical way.

[02:08:20] there are very few very few cases in which medical malpractice cap is ever reached many of these cases though involving cases of medical malpractice that do involve the cap they're very complex cases that frequently take five six seven years in order to be able to get to court and if there was no cap verdict in some of those cases there may be medical expenses of two and a half million dollars in those cases and the verdict might have been much much higher

[02:08:57] in the event that we didn't have a cap but so people can't recover that and that's covered by current law but the additional problem is that they don't get the time value of the money for the five six seven years that that case is pending. Average rate of return for companies sitting on that money is 11 to 14 percent. Insurance companies get the float. The judgment rate of interest is six and a half percent. There are probably, I don't know, a half dozen cases

[02:09:33] that this would have applied to over the past year or two and would have permitted pre-judgment interest to exceed the cap. Doesn't change the cap, It just exempts prejudgment interest from it in those rare cases where a verdict is entered in the amount of the cap and the injured party ought to receive the time value of that money.

[02:10:02] The question is, shall Senate Bill 536 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[02:10:20] Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. Senate Bill 536 passes. Senate Bill 599: A bill relating to Virginia opioid use reduction and jail-based substance use disorder treatment and transition fund grant procedures.

[02:10:39] Junior Senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass. I'm speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Madam President, Senate Bill 599 is a sustainability and public health measure that strengthens the Virginia opioid use reduction and jail-based substance use disorder treatment and transition program called JSUT, developed from the recommendations of the Joint Commission on Health Care.

[02:11:05] This bill ensures that the grant funding remains available to more localities by establishing a three-year limit for awards and requiring applicants to demonstrate a plan for long-term self-sufficiency. By prioritizing program sustainability, we can expand access to life-saving treatment and recovery services in our local and regional jails while maximizing the impact of our limited resources.

[02:11:33] I hope it's a will of the body to adopt this bill. Thank you, Madam President. The question is, shall Senate Bill 599 pass? in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the

senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero senate bill 599 passes senate bill 637 a bill relating to

[02:12:04] virginia human rights act definition of employer senator from alexandria i move the bill pass and and speaking to that motion. -Senator has the floor. -We passed the Virginia Values Act in 2020 with strong 30 to 9 support, and this is some updates, and I'd like to just go through them very briefly.

[02:12:29] One of them is it clarifies the size of an employer that's covered. Originally, we had kind of a hybrid model that employers that harassed an employee or sexually harassed them and they quit only covered if they were larger employers but smaller employers were covered for if they fired a person unlawfully and this just equalizes that to six employees or more for both categories.

[02:12:58] Further, it includes people which was the original intent to the Virginia Human Rights Act. It applies to minors except in cases where age is context where discrimination is based on their age like under people under 18 can't vote under 16 can't drive but there's the current wording has been interpreted not to cover minors at all so we do that under this um further we put a statute of limitations on claims for two years there was no statute of limitations specified originally

[02:13:36] and that had caused some confusion with the prior attorney general's office uh that's what the bill does, and I again renew my motion that it pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 637 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close

[02:14:04] the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 637 passes. Senate Bill 643, a bill relating to firearm purchase requirements, penalties. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, can that bill go by for the day? Without objection, Senate Bill 643 goes by for the day. Senate Bill 790, a bill relating to health

[02:14:39] insurance, mandated benefits, treatment of menopause and pre-menopause. Senator from Hanover. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass and speaking to the motion senator has the floor madam president uh this is bill that we've not seen on the floor before to my to my recollection but this deals with insurance coverage for treatment for menopause and perimenopause many of y'all might say why is the gentleman from hanover

[02:15:11] bringing this bill madam president i'm happy to answer that question for you madam senator has the for. Madam President, as y'all might know, my family has dealt with cancer like many of your families have, but in dealing with that, menopause coming early at a very young age is part of the ramifications of dealing with that disease. And all the things that you see in this bill

[02:15:42] that now will be covered through health insurance treatment, things from bladder loss, Loss of bone density, lack of sleep, impacts like your cholesterol level, all those things in addition to hot flashes at all are very impactful. As we are looking at how we can make Virginians lives better, there are a number of Virginians that will now have these treatment options covered by their insurance because of the passage of this legislation.

[02:16:16] So, I hope that you will join me in moving this forward and making these items covered for the members of our society who deal with this, whether it's too early in life or in the normal course. Thank you, Madam President.

[02:16:32] Senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I am so happy to hear my colleague on the other side of the aisle acknowledge the profound impact that perimenopause and menopause can have on a woman's life.

[02:16:52] And I will remind my colleagues that when I brought forth the bill to ensure that there is no work discrimination against women who are going through these very difficult times in their life, it passed on a party-line vote.

[02:17:08] So I will encourage those on my side of the aisle to please vote in favor of this bill and acknowledge that these are indeed intense difficult times for people and um we should respect that and encourage all to protect them thank you senator from mecklenburg thank you madam president um may i speak to the bill please the senator has the floor i would just like to

[02:17:45] the senate will be in order in order please um i want to speak to the bill and clarify why the members on my side of the aisle probably didn't vote for the other legislation that care that covered this um probably because we believe that covering health insurance benefits for treatment of perimenopause and menopause is the correct way to ensure that women are treated fairly for this important time of our lives and that we do not believe that women need to be

[02:18:21] accommodated in the workplace and that we believe that women are strong independent women and that we can work just as hard as men even when we are dealing with that decade or so of hot flashes and other being irritable and so forth and we are glad to see that senator mcdougall feels our pain understands what we're going through and he is maybe maybe he's the sweet senator

[02:18:55] and not senator stanley thank you madam chair madam madam president the question is shall senate bill 790 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes i those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll i was 40 no zero eyes 40 no zero senate bill 790 passes

[02:19:30] senate bill 834 a bill relating to virginia solar energy and battery energy storage systems grant program the chair recognizes the senator from richmond city madam president i move the bill passed and speaking to that bill senator has the floor yes well thank you madam president um we're asking that the department of energy shall establish virginia solar energy and battery energy storage systems grant program for the purpose of coordinating and supporting the

[02:20:04] development of solar energy and short duration battery energy storage uh in industries and projects by public or private entities madam president i just move that to bill pass the question is shall senate bill 834 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll i was 21 nose 19 eyes 21 nose 19 senate

[02:20:41] bill 834 passes returning to page one senate bill 348 senator from northern fairfax senator from northern fairfax pardon me i was not i was not ready for you um so having previously described

[02:21:14] the bill on safe storage for saving children's lives i moved the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 348 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll i was 21 nos 19. ayes 21 nos 19 senate bill 348 passes

[02:21:48] on page 4. senator from alexandria bill 314. thank you madam president i move the bill pass and speaking to that senator has the floor um previously i explained the bill but i just want to remind people this allows um public private partnerships to use tourism improvement districts in a more compatible way and further would allow places with the county manager former government to increase their transit occupancy tax to much less than all the other places in the state

[02:22:24] that use them for tourism promotion i move the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 314 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close

[02:22:48] the roll i was 23 no 17 eyes 23 no 17 senate bill 314 passes on page 6 senate bill 305 the senator from western fairfax madam president i'm gonna ask that this bill go by for the day so i have have the opportunity to work with the senator from Rockingham and make sure we all feel good about our votes and the posture of the bill. Without objections

[02:23:22] Senate Bill 305 goes by for the day. Uncontested calendar, Senate bills on second reading. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all the Senate bills are now on third reading. Sorry, wrong page. Madam President, I move that all the Senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendars on pages 13 and 14, Senate Bill 342-805 be advanced in engrossment and third reading in the block of the adoption of any amendments thereto. Any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block shall do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, shall all the Senate

[02:24:02] bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 13 through 14, Senate Bill 342 through Senate Bill 805 be engrossed in advance to their third reading in the block after the adoption of the amendments thereto, that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The clerk will read the number of the

[02:24:33] bill. Senate Bill 342, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. Senate Bill 660, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. Senate Bill 800, reported from the Committee on Local Government. Senate Bill 805, reported from the Committee on Local Government.

[02:24:55] The question is, shall the Senate bills be engrossed and advanced to their third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The bills are engrossed and advanced to their third reading. Senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[02:25:20] Madam President, I move that all the Senate bills now in third reading on the uncontested calendars, pages 13 and 14, Senate Bills 342 to 805, that the rules be suspended in the third constitutional reading and the titles be dispensed with. The question is, shall the rules be suspended in the third reading of the titles of the bills be dispensed with? All in favor of the motion will record their votes.

[02:25:37] Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero the reading of the titles is dispensed with the bills are now before the Senate on final passage senator from Eastern Henrico not yet Eastern Fairfax when will you move madam president really want me to move madam president I move that all the

[02:26:16] Senate bill is now on third reading uncontested counter on pages 13 and 14 symbols 343 data 5 be placed in final patch in the block any senators I move bill from the block please do so after the clerk has read the number the resolution the question is shall the Senate bills on the uncontested calendar now on their third reading pages 13 through 14 Senate bill 342 through Senate bill 805 be placed on their final passage in the block with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no

[02:26:52] the ayes have it the motion is agreed to the bills are before us in the block the clerk will read the number of the bills senate bill 342 senate bill 660 senate bill 800 senate bill 805 the question is shall the bills in the block now pass that is all in favor of the passage of the bills will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted Do any Senators desire to change their vote?

[02:27:30] The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no 0. Ayes 40, no 0. The bills in the block pass. Regular calendar. Senate bills on second reading.

[02:27:47] Senate Bill 94, a bill relating to siting of data centers, property zone for industrial use. Reported from the Committee on Local Government with amendments. and there is a substitute and a floor amendment to the substitute, two floor amendments to the substitute.

[02:28:09] Senator from Western, Prince William. There you go, Madam President. Thank you, Madam President. So we're going to have a few parts of the dance here, so hang with me here. First one is we are going to, I'm going to move to reject the local government committee amendments. With the recommendation that they be rejected, the question is, shall the amendments from the committee on local government be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed no. No. The no's have it. The amendments from local government are rejected. All right thank you madam president. Madam president good job everyone on round one.

[02:28:44] Let's go to round two. This time we are going to agree to these I've moved to agree to the committee substitute from the senate finance and appropriations committee. The question is shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye aye any opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to all right thank you madam president now madam president we are going to uh i'm going to withdraw the first floor amendment without objection the first floor amendment is withdrawn great thank you uh madam president i'm now going to waive the reading i move to waive the reading of the second floor

[02:29:21] amendment the question is shall the reading of the second floor amendment be waived all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye any opposed no the ayes have it the reading is waived okay thank you madam president now madam president i'm going to move adoption of the second floor amendment and speaking to that motion senator has the floor all right thank you madam president first off nice job everyone we're all hung together now here's what this one does so you'll notice that the title of this bill is citing of data centers property zoned for industrial use the substitute that came out of

[02:29:56] the senate finance committee dealt with senator ebbins introduced bill or should say the senator from alexander's introduced bill same one that cleared last year once the governor got vetoed and so that language all still holds not no words in that bill changes at all what we have done is we've taken the core of the bill that came out of local government we changed the words data center to heuf which is high

energy use facility in order to draw that to the substitute language from the center from alexandria's bill so that's the first thing the second thing why we

[02:30:35] did the second one here is upon request i was asked for the july 1st 2026 deadline to be extended into January 1st, 2027 to give localities more time to adjust. Fair enough, happy to do that. Next thing that I did with this is we made sure explicitly that this only applies to localities with zoning ordinances. There are a very small handful of localities that do not have zoning ordinances, and so we wanted to include them, and so Southwest, Southside, I got you all, took care of you all. So that now leads us to where we are. What does this do? What this does

[02:31:11] is it would limit data center siting in localities to industrially zoned areas. Now, if you have a site plan, does that mean that if you have it, you won't be able to get it approved at all? No, what it means is that the locality would have to have a rezoning to have it be established as an industrially zoned area.

[02:31:35] The reason for that is we want local recognition that these modern facilities are not the same that we saw in 2012, 2014, when some of them were being allowed in regular commercially zoned areas.

[02:31:51] This all came up in the JLARC report. It's called Data Centers in Virginia, came out in September of 2024. Give it a read. Part of that report talked about how these are inherently the modern ones are industrial use. On the one hand, they'd said, hey, you don't need to have the state tell the localities what to do with it.

[02:32:09] on the other hand they implored the localities to do this so i introduced this bill last year and said hey if all the localities that want to have data centers adjust their own ordinances to accomplish this great no need for my bill that has not happened in its totality so that's what this does again if your locality wants to be able to have a data center they can still do that under this bill they just need to limit it to industrially zoned area or rezone one area to industrial zoning in order to approve a site plan thank you madam

[02:32:44] president the question is shall the floor amendment number two be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye any opposed no the eyes have it the amendment is agreed to madam president senator from Western Prince William thank you madam president madam president I move to the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading but seeing eight hands this will now be a recorded vote on the floor amendment number 2. The question is, shall the floor

[02:33:21] amendment number 2 be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 24, noes 16. Ayes 24, noes 16. The floor Amendment is agreed to. Senator from Western Prince William. Move to engrossed and advance. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed and

[02:33:58] advanced to his third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 94 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Does the senator wish to speak on the previous bill? No, this one. The clerk will Read the number of the bill.

[02:34:28] Senate Bill 15: A bill relating to driver improvement clinics, motorcycle driver improvement clinics, motorcycle driver improvement clinic fund created. Senator from Roanoke. Thank you, Madam President. I ask that the bill go by for the day.

[02:34:45] Without objection, Senate Bill 15 goes by for the day. Senate Bill 670: A bill relating to automated driving systems reported from the Committee on Transportation with amendments reported from the committee on finance and appropriations with a substitute and there is two floor substitutes there are two floor substitutes senator from central fairfax

[02:35:24] thank you madam president madam president with the recommendation that the amendments from the committee on transportation be rejected i move that the amendments be agreed to with the recommendation that the amendments be rejected the question is shall the recommendations from the committee on transportation be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no no the one no has it the the amendment is amendments are rejected senator from central Fairfax thank you madam president with the recommendation that the substitute from the committee

[02:36:03] on Finance and Appropriations be rejected, I move that the substitute be agreed to. With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:36:20] Those opposed, no. No. The noes have it. The substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations is rejected. Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. - Madam President, with that, I would like to withdraw the floor substitute number one.

[02:36:36] - Without objection, floor substitute number one is withdrawn. Senator from Central Fairfax. - Thank you, Madam President. I move that the reading of the floor substitute be waived. - The question is, shall the reading of the floor substitute be waived?

[02:36:52] All in favor of that motion will say aye. - Aye. - Those opposed, no. The ayes have it, the reading is waived. Senator from Central Fairfax. - Thank you, Madam President. move that the floor substitute be agreed to and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Uh, Madam President and ladies and gentlemen of the body, uh, the substitute has just tightens up some of the language on the autonomous vehicle, uh, autonomous vehicle bill, uh, to ensure that we add, uh, that the autonomous operating certificate, uh, process goes to the DMV along with making sure that the Virginia, um, there's a provision that was added

[02:37:31] to ensure that operational security at our airports who's expected to see large number of passengers from DC arrived by Waymo that they have some control over that and of course this is we tighten some of the security and safety components to get this into sort of the peace in the valley version madam president with that I move that the floor substitute be agreed to the The question is, shall the floor substitute number 2 for Senate Bill 670 be agreed to?

[02:38:04] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The floor substitute is agreed to. Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to his third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 670 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading?

[02:38:23] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 23, a bill relating to plea agreements and court orders prohibited provisions reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments.

[02:38:42] Senator from Central Fairfax. Madam President, I move that the Committee amendments be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to?

All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. amendments are agreed to. Senator from Central Fairfax. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 23 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed in advance. Senate Bill 26, a bill relating to land development,

[02:39:22] solar canopies in surface parking areas, reported from the Committee on Local Government with a substitute and there is a floor amendment. Senator from Eastern Prince William. Madam President, I move that the local government substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the committee on local government be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Prince William. Madam President, I move that the reading of the amendment be waived. The question is, shall the reading of the floor amendment

[02:40:00] be waived. All in favor of the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The reading is waived. Senator from Prince William. Madam President, I move that the amendment be agreed to and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This amendment will enable localities to exempt property owners for locations that don't produce enough solar power to pay for themselves. Developers must prove that the panels will produce less than 75% of the energy they were produced if they were placed in a perfectly sunny unobstructed spot in the same area.

[02:40:34] They must prove this lack of efficiency using a P90 energy value. The question is, shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Aye.

[02:40:49] Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The floor amendment is agreed to. Senator from Prince William. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 26 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:41:05] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 87. A bill relating to local government sporting events and sporting facilities, automated external defibrillators.

[02:41:24] Senator from Hanover. I'm sorry. Senator from Franklin County. Oh, no. It's embarrassing more for me than it is for you. Madam President, I move that the committee substitute be agreed to.

[02:41:41] The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Local Government be agreed to? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. I now move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading.

[02:41:59] The question is, shall the bill, Senate Bill 87, now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 123, a bill which provided a charter for the city of Pocosin relating to schools, reported from the Committee on Local Government.

[02:42:24] Senator from York. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading. Question is, shall Senate Bill 123 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[02:42:40] The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 189, a bill relating to Virginia Consumer Protection Act, Consumer Notification in Consumer Debt Collection Proceedings, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute, and there is a floor amendment.

[02:43:01] Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the substitute from Courts of Justice be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to?

[02:43:16] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the reading of the floor amendment be waived. The question is, shall the reading of the floor amendment be waived?

[02:43:34] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The reading is waived. Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the floor amendment be agreed to. Would the senator like to speak to that motion? And speaking to that motion, the floor amendment simply adds a provision of the enacted of the effective date to be January 1, 2027. The question is, shall the floor amendment be agreed to. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The floor

[02:44:13] amendment is agreed to. Senator from Norfolk. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 189 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 296, a bill relating to county manager conformed plan of government affordable dwelling unit ordinance reported from the committee on local government with a substitute senator from Arlington thank you madam president madam president I move that

[02:44:52] the substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on local government be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 296 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 301, a bill relating to exemptions from garnishment, minimum protected

[02:45:29] amount balance, certain benefit payments, procedure for financial institutions, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments. Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, I move the Committee amendments be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to.

[02:45:56] Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading the question is shall senate bill 301 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 335 a bill relating to affirmative defense or reduced penalty for mental illness neurorecognitive disorder or intellectual developmental disability reported from the committee for courts of justice with amendments

[02:46:31] senator from Northern Fairfax thank you madam president I move the committee amendments be agreed to the question is shall the amendments from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the amendments are agreed to senator from Fairfax thank you madam president I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading the question is shall Senate bill 335 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have

[02:47:02] it the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 416 a bill relating to deferred disposition in a criminal case persons with autism intellectual disabilities or developmental disabilities expungement reported from the committee for courts of justice with amendments senator from northern fairfax thank you madam president i move the committee amendments the question is shall the amendments from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the amendments are agreed to senator from fairfax thank

[02:47:42] you madam president i move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading the question is shall senate bill 416 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading all All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and advanced.

[02:47:58] Senate Bill 531, a bill relating to zoning, development, and use of necessary accessory dwelling units reported from the Committee on Local Government with a substitute.

[02:48:14] The junior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Local Government be agreed All in favor of the motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to.

[02:48:31] Junior Senator from Loudoun. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 531 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no.

[02:48:46] The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Uncontested calendar, Senate bill is on first reading. Senator from Alexandria. I would ask that we return to page 4 to reconsider the vote by which we passed SB 314 so a member can have their vote properly recorded as they intended.

[02:49:08] Did you say page 4, Senator? Yes, page 4, SB 314. Madam President. Senator from Hanover.

[02:49:25] Madam President, I want to thank the Senator for bringing this back up, even though he knows that this requires unanimous consent in order to be reconsidered and appreciate his courtesies. The question is, shall the vote by which the Senate Bill 314 passed be reconsidered? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close

[02:50:03] the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. The motion is agreed to. Senator from Alexandria. Having previously explained the bill again I move the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate bill 314 on page 4 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[02:50:36] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 314 passes.

[02:50:53] Uncontested calendar. Senate bills on first reading. The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria.

[02:51:08] Madam President, I move that all Senate bills on first reading of the uncontested and regular calendars, page 21 through 51, SB 3 through SB 827, that the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with.

[02:51:26] The question is, shall the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles of the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars, pages 21 through 51, Senate Bill 3 through Senate Bill 827 be dispensed with? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no.

[02:51:45] Are the senators ready to vote? all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no 0. Ayes 40, no 0. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry of the clerk, does that complete today's calendar? We need to have the bills go by

[02:52:20] for the day. I'm sorry, ask that all those bills go by for the day. The question is, shall the the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars now on their second reading be passed by for the day. All in favor of the motion will say aye. Those opposed no. The ayes have it. The

[02:52:39] bills will go by for the day. The Senate will be in order. The calendar is not complete. The Senate

[02:53:11] will be in order. Regular calendar Senate joint resolutions on third reading. Senate joint resolution 23 directing the joint legislative audit review commission to study the need for and feasibility of creating a secretariat of rural affairs in the Commonwealth report senator from Eastern Henrico thank you I'm so much

[02:53:46] madam president I move the resolution be agreed to the question is shall Senate joint resolution 23 be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any Any opposed no? The ayes have it. The ayes have it. SJR 23 is agreed to.

[02:54:12] Senate Joint Resolution 26, directing the Joint Legislative Audit and Review Commission to study the potential impacts of expanded discretionary parole eligibility report. Senior Senator from Fairfax.

[02:54:27] Thank you, Madam President. I move that the resolution pass. And speaking of that motion. Senator has the floor. 30 years ago, we abolished parole. We have 30 years of data. We have 30 years of information and experience. I think it's time we did a study to take a look at perhaps expanding or looking at the potential for expanding discretionary parole. And again, I reiterate my motion that the resolution be agreed to the question is shall SJR 26 be agreed to all in favor

[02:55:02] of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it SJR 26 is agreed to senator from Eastern Fairfax madam president is that complete today's calendar mr. madam clerk yes sir is there any other business to come before for the Senate.

[02:55:32] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. - Madam President, rise for an announcement. - Senator has the floor. - Quick point of personal privilege. - Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, the Senate, a couple of administrative things I wanted to make sure everybody was aware of going forward.

[02:55:48] First of all, tomorrow, you all have looked, we have a rather lengthy bunch of first reads we did today. And in light of the fact that we have to have a Congress and Labor Committee meeting tomorrow along with a finance meeting, the Minority Leader suggested we not take second uncontested through tomorrow and we concur that's a good idea so we're not going to do that tomorrow tomorrow we'll just do things as we normally do secondly i know in the past we've often if we need to amend a bill it's on third read we take it back to second make the amendments then take it all the way through to third we've been talking about how it's probably more efficient

[02:56:27] to take things back to second make the amendment and then just let the bill go forward to the next day it'll save us probably two or three minutes per bill and who knows maybe 30 minutes by the the end of session given how often that tends to happen so just be aware of that hopefully we'll change that default process going forward the other thing I want to mention is that yesterday during the debate we had there was some conversation about governor's appointments and I just want to remind everybody that it's typically the protocol of the Senate not to talk about the specific names of people that are mentioned in the resolutions that's typically how we've handled things here and I just want to remind everybody of

[02:57:03] that that was suggested to me that we remind everybody that and really quickly Thank you, Madam President, a point of personal privilege. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, I know we're working on a budget right now, trying to figure out revenue estimates and how to maintain our bond rating, produce a fiscally prudent budget, etc.

[02:57:24] And we had a little bit of conversation earlier in session about what the state of the economy was and also the state of the Virginia economy. I just want to note for everybody that this morning, the U.S. Department of Labor came out the report that said the U.S. economy added 130,000 jobs in January. And that's the headline.

[02:57:45] But the interesting part is if you look at the footnote, footnotes in that release from the U.S. Department of Labor, they actually revised job growth for the entire year of last year. And, you know, the U.S. Department of Labor has been having some issues getting its reports out because they had some shutdown issues and some employment employees fired etc but the um department of labor revised the job growth for all of last year in the united states of america down to 181 000 jobs

[02:58:21] for the entire year so so we're clear basically job growth in the in the country last year collapsed it was the worst year for hiring in america outside of a recession since 2003. and so i just think as we go forward with our budget and we think about the risks our economy faces going forward and how prudent we need to be I just want to make sure everybody's aware that the American economy is not very healthy right now tariffs I think are having their effect and the actions of the federal government are especially having their effect here in our state as we try to guide our

[02:59:00] economy forward and build ourselves a prudent budget and I just think it's important highlighting for everybody here that job growth is not in a good place and last year was a lot worse than i think people realized thank you madam president thank you senator the chair recognizes the senior senator from virginia beach thank you madam president i rise for an announcement senator has the floor madam president i wanted to remind everybody about the aviation caucus tomorrow morning at 8 a.m in room 600b um and if you want to attend please come and madam president while i'm standing i wasn't going to do this but i

[02:59:39] rise for a quick point of personal privilege. Senator has the floor. And Madam President, I wanted to remind folks that we had a pretty good budget surplus last year. So for the state of Virginia, although certain numbers come out and they showed that we may not have had a great year for job growth in some certain areas, but in the state of Virginia, we had a pretty good surplus last year. And I'd like to thank our last governor and our last administration for that. Thank you. Thank you, Senator. The clerk will report any announcements

[03:00:17] on the desk. Today, Wednesday, February 11th, the Committee for Courts of Justice will meet 30 minutes after adjournment, Senate Room A, GAB. The Committee on General Laws and Technology will meet 30 minutes after adjournment in Senate Room B, GAB. Tomorrow, Thursday, February the 12th, The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Health and Human Resources will meet at 7:30 a.m. in the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th Floor, GAB.

[03:00:49] The Hampton Roads Caucus will meet at 7:30 a.m. in House South Conference Room 700A, GAB. The Committee on Education and Health will meet at 8:30 a.m. Senate Room A, GAB. The Democratic caucus will meet at 11:15 a.m. in Senate Room 1 of the Capitol.

[03:01:10] The Republican caucus will meet at 11:30 a.m. in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. Roses are red. Ballots are blue. Shopping days are few. Senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[03:01:30] Thank you, Madam President Rice, for an announcement. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I just want to tell everybody that the Courts of Justice Committee needs to meet 15 minutes after adjournment. We have, I think about 30 bills to get through, and whatever we don't get through today, we will get to on Monday.

[03:01:48] Minority leaders agree that we can waive reads for anything we don't get to today, provided we prioritize a few bills. But we still need to get started quick, so 15 minutes. Senator from Portsmouth. I'm sorry, Senator from Roanoke.

[03:02:04] Senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that we do now adjourn until 12 noon or tomorrow. The question is, shall the Senate now adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow?

[03:02:21] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The Senate stands adjourned until 12 noon tomorrow.

[03:02:33] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

[03:03:50] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate chamber.

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[03:08:29] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[03:10:11] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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[03:15:08] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[03:16:32] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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[03:20:48] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[03:22:52] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

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[03:28:09] The Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

[03:29:49] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

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[03:33:29] The Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:34:33] Senate Chamber. This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:37:39] Senate Chamber.

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[03:39:58] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:41:48] Chamber.

[03:41:55] The Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:43:59] Chamber. Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[03:46:28] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:47:38] Senate Chamber. This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:50:20] Chamber. Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[03:52:30] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

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[04:05:54] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[04:06:17] Senate Chamber.

[04:07:18] The Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[04:09:58] Senate Chamber.

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[04:11:32] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia

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[04:17:53] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia

[04:18:57] chamber this is the senate of virginia richmond virginia committee room 1300 test test thank you

[06:05:26] for joining us this concludes this broadcast of the senate of virginia in richmond virginia

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[06:09:07] past meetings and explore our full archives anytime on the senate of virginia's youtube channel

[06:09:13] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[06:11:00] Senate Committee Room, 1300.